

Chapter-8

The Pronoun

Read the passage given below carefully.

Rohan and **Rohan's** father were at railway station, waiting for the train to Delhi. Rohan told **Rohan's** father that **Rohan** had forgotten to bring **Rohan's** camera. **Rohan's father** asked **Rohan** what **Rohan** had to do with **Rohan's** camera. Rohan told **Rohan's** father that **Rohan** wanted to click some photographs with Rohan's camera when **Rohan and Rohan's father** would visit the famous places at Delhi.

The repetition of the words 'Rohan' and 'Rohan's father' makes it rather awkward. Now read the revised version of the same passage with some words replaced.

Rohan and **his** father were at railway station, waiting for the train to Delhi. **He** told **his** father that **he** had forgotten to bring **his** camera. **His** father asked **him** what **he** had to do with **his** camera. **He** told **his** father that **he** wanted to click some photographs with **his** camera when **they** would visit the famous places at Delhi.

You can observe that the revised version of the passage seems refined as there is no repetition of the noun 'Rohan'. It has been replaced with the words 'he', 'his' or 'him'. Similarly, the nouns 'Rohan and Rohan's father' have been replaced with the word 'they'. These words that replace the nouns are called pronouns.

Definition: The word pronoun means 'used in place of noun'. A pronoun is a word which is used in place of a noun. Thus, a pronoun replaces a noun.

Kinds of Pronouns

Sr. No	Kind of Pronoun	Examples
1	Personal Pronouns	I, we, me, us, my, mine, our, ours, you, your, yours, he, him, his, she, her, hers, it, its, they, them, their, theirs
2	Possessive Pronouns	mine, ours, his, hers, its, theirs, yours
3	Demonstrative Pronouns	this, that, these, those etc.
4	Interrogative Pronoun	who, whose, whom, what, which
5	Reflexive Pronoun	myself, ourselves, himself, herself, themselves etc.
6	Emphatic Pronoun	myself, ourselves, himself, herself, themselves etc.
7	Indefinite Pronoun	one, some, all, few, any, many, somebody, anyone, everything, nothing, nobody, anything, something, everyone etc.
8	Distributive Pronouns	each, either, neither
9	Relative Pronouns	who, what, which, whose, whom, that, as

Exercise: Underline the pronouns in the following sentences.

1. He is a famous politician. Everyone likes him.
2. She is new to this city. She doesn't know anyone here.
3. We must follow the traffic rules. It is safe for all.
4. Rohan lives in Hyderabad which is a big city. He runs a business there.
5. That is my new bicycle gifted to me by my father.
6. This is the man who repaired my car. He charged me 500 rupees for this.
7. Somebody is knocking at the door. Will you please open it?
8. If I go to Delhi, I will bring a new phone for you.
9. You look tired today. You must rest.
10. My mother prepared tasty dishes for us.
11. All is well that ends well.
12. One must do one's duty.
13. Each of these dresses is beautiful.
14. This is a beautiful house. I want to buy it for myself.
15. She is the girl whose notebook has not been corrected.

Personal Pronouns

Personal pronouns are the words used for persons or things. There are three types of personal pronouns.

(i) First Person Pronouns: 'I' and 'We' are the first person pronouns. These are used for the person/persons speaking. 'I' is used for one person whereas 'we' is used for many persons.

(ii) Second Person Pronouns: 'You' is second person pronoun. It is used for the person/persons spoken to. 'You' has the same form for singular and plural pronouns.

(iii) Third Persons Pronouns: 'He', 'she', 'it' and 'they' are third person pronouns. These pronouns are used for the persons or things spoken of. 'He' is used to denote masculine gender, 'she' is used to denote feminine gender and 'it' is used for animals, non-living things and a baby when the gender is not specified. Although 'it' is used for non-living things, it is included in personal pronouns. Sometimes, 'it' is also called impersonal pronoun.

Personal Pronouns : Case

Read the following sentences carefully.

1. **Me** am going to market.
2. He helped **I** a lot.
3. **Him** is a good boy.
4. **Their** are playing cricket.
5. Mrs. Sharma is completing **his** work.
6. The students are doing **his** homework.
7. The cat licked **her** paw.
8. Smita washed **its** clothes.
9. You must do **yours** duty.

THINK: Do you observe anything awkward in the above sentences?

The words in bold are all pronouns, but their form is not correct according to gender, number and their place and function in the sentence.

Just as nouns can be used as subjects, direct objects, indirect objects and to show possession in different sentences, pronouns can also be used in various ways. The use of pronouns in sentences decides their case. There are three cases of pronouns.

1. **Subjective Case (Subject Pronouns):** A pronouns used as a subject is said to be in subjective case.

Examples:

Subject	Predicate
He	is a good boy.
She	is my elder sister.
They	are watching T.V.

In the above examples, 'He', 'She' and 'They' are the doers of the action or verb. The predicate in each sentence tells us something about 'He', 'She' or 'They'. These pronouns are subjects in the sentences; hence their case is subjective case.

2. **Objective Case: (Object Pronoun):** A pronoun used as direct or indirect object is said to be in objective case.

Examples:

Subject	Predicate		
	Verb	Indirect Object	Direct Object
You	helped	-	me.
We	invited	-	you.
I	will not disturb	-	him.
He	gifted	me	a book.
She	asked	him	a question.

3. **Possessive Case: (Possessive Pronoun):** A pronoun that shows possession is said to be in possessive case.

Example: This is **his** car.

Or,
This car is **his**.

Study the tables given below to understand different forms and cases of personal pronouns.

Person	Forms of Pronouns Placed before the verb (Subject Pronouns) Subjective Case		Forms of Pronouns Placed after the verb (Object Pronouns) Objective Case		Forms of Pronouns to show Possession (Possessive Pronouns) Possessive Case			
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Possessive Pronoun		Possessive Adjective	
					Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
First Person	I	we	me	us	mine	ours	my	our
Second Person	you	you	you	you	yours	yours	your	your
Third Person	he	they	him	them	his	theirs	his	their
	she	they	her	them	hers	theirs	her	their
	it	they	it	them	its	theirs	its	their

Use of Possessive Pronouns as Possessive Adjectives

Both possessive pronouns and possessive adjectives are used to show possession or belonging. However, whereas pronouns replace the nouns, adjectives describe the nouns. Examples:

1. This is **my** book.
2. This book is **mine**.

In the examples given above, the words 'my' and 'mine' both show possession. They both are personal pronouns. However, the word 'my' is followed by the noun 'book'. It modifies the noun 'book'; hence it is called possessive adjective. On the other hand, the word 'mine' is used in place of the noun 'book'. It is called possessive pronoun.

Study the table given below to understand the use of possessive pronouns and possessive adjectives.

Possessive Pronoun	Possessive Adjective
This car is his .	This is his car.
That house is yours .	That is your house.
These bags are theirs	These are their bags.
This pencil is hers .	This is her pencil.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with personal pronouns.

1. Radhika bought a book.read.....again and again.
2. Kunal did not take the class test.was fined by.....teacher.
3. You and.....friend have finished.....work.
4. Kim is wearing a beautiful frock.is looking very pretty.
5. Rachna is not well.cannot attendclass today.
6. They have done.....work.
7.must obey your elders.
8.is raining outside.
9. India is.....country.are proud of its rich heritage.
10.has cleaned her room.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with personal pronouns.

1. The child is crying.seems to be hungry.
2. This is Preeti's bag. Give.....to.....
3. Sir, when will.....return from Delhi?
4. Rajan, this pencil is.....and that is.....
5.is very hot today.
6. Our neighbours are going to renovate their house. I will renovate
7. Show him your notebook. He will show you
8. Take these notebooks and keep.....on the shelf.
9. How may.....help you?
10. How dare.....talk to me like this?

Exercise: Underline the pronouns in the following sentences. Rewrite the following sentences by correcting the wrong pronouns.

1. Me am going to market to buy a new bag for mine.
.....
2. He helped I a lot, so me am thankful to his.
.....
3. His is a good boy. Us like his a lot.
.....
4. Their have been playing cricket for two hours. Call they back now.
.....
5. Mrs. Sharma is completing his work. You should not disturb him.
.....
6. The students are doing his homework. Then them will play.
.....
7. The cat licked her paw. She had injured itself.
.....
8. My friend locked my in mine room, but somehow I got me out.
.....
9. There teacher corrected there notebooks.
.....
10. Shweta sings very well. I always admire she.
.....

11. I took my friend's book thinking it to be my.

12. The boys will complete his homework.

13. Mr. Sharma has bought a new car for him son.

14. Rohan and his friends have submitted there assignments to the teacher.

15. Arpita is going to airport to receive she parents. Them are returning from Delhi today.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with possessive pronouns:

1. My brother completed his homework and I completed.....
2. Our house is big, but.....is bigger than
3. We decorated our classroom, and they decorated.....
4. My mother purchased her new clothes and my father purchased.....
5. I shall go my way, and you go.....

Demonstrative Pronouns

Definition: The words 'this', 'that', 'these', 'those' are called demonstratives as they are used to point out to persons or things they refer to.

Look at the use of demonstrative pronouns in the following sentences.

1. **This** is my pencil. (Used for singular thing which is near the speaker)
2. **That** is your car. (Used for singular thing which is at a distance from the speaker)
3. **These** are his kites. (Used for plural things which are near the speaker)
4. These oranges are fresher than **those** we saw in the market. (Used for plural things which are at a distance from the speaker)

Demonstrative Pronouns and Demonstrative Adjectives

Both demonstrative pronouns and demonstrative adjectives are used to point out to a person or a thing they refer to. However, whereas demonstrative pronouns replace the nouns, demonstrative adjectives are placed before the nouns to describe the nouns. Examples:

Demonstrative Pronoun	Demonstrative Adjective
This is my book.	This book is mine.
That is your house.	That house is yours.
These are their bags.	These bags are theirs
This is her pencil.	This pencil is hers.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with correct demonstrative pronouns/ demonstrative adjectives.

1.is a beautiful flower.
2.is a very shining star.
3.car is bigger than at my office.
4. is a kite flying in the sky.
5.books are better than
6. Both the dresses are beautiful, but.....is more beautiful than.....
7. The climate of Tamilnadu is hotter than of Jammu and Kashmir.
8. The oranges of Nagpur are better than.....of any other state.
9.house on the hill is more beautiful than.....
10.boats in the sea look smaller thanon the shore.

Interrogative Pronouns

Definition: The words ‘what’, ‘which’, ‘who’, ‘whose’ and ‘whom’ are interrogative pronouns. They are used to ask questions about persons or things.

- Examples:**
1. **What** are you doing here?
 2. **Who** are these boys?
 3. **Which** is your favourite colour?
 4. **Whom** did you convey the message?
 5. **Whose** is this house?

Important Note:

‘Who’, ‘whom’ and ‘whose’ are used for persons.

‘What’ is used for things.

‘Which’ is used for persons and things. ‘Which’ is used to denote selection of one or many out of the given options.

Example: Which of these dresses do you like the most?

Forms of Interrogative Pronouns

	Subjective Case	Objective Case	Possessive Case
For persons	who	whom	Whose
For things	what	what	-
For persons or things	which	which	-

Read the following sentences to understand the subjective, objective and possessive cases of interrogative pronouns.

1. **What** is that big thing?
2. **What** did you buy at market?
3. **Whose** is this book?

In example 1 ‘what’ is the subject of the verb ‘is’, whereas in example 2 ‘what’ is the object of the verb ‘buy’. The word ‘whose’ shows possession; hence it is in possessive case.

Interrogative Pronoun and Interrogative Adjective

Interrogative pronouns, 'what', 'which' and 'whose' can also be used as interrogative adjectives. interrogative adjectives are interrogative words followed immediately by a noun.

Examples:

1. Which of these books do you find the most interesting?
2. Which book do you like the most?

In the first sentence given above, the word which refers to the noun 'book', but it is not followed by the noun 'book'. It replaces the noun 'book'; hence it is interrogative pronoun. In the second example, the interrogative word 'which' is followed by the noun, 'book'. It describes the noun, 'book'. Hence it is interrogative adjective.

Interrogative Pronoun	Interrogative Adjective
Which is your book?	Which book is yours?
What is the news he broke to you?	What news did he break to you?
Whose is this house?	Whose house is this?

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with correct pronouns.

1.is your name?
2.has broken the window?
3.have you invited to your birthday party?
4. is your book?
5.is this pen?

Exercise: Underline the interrogative words in the following sentences. State whether they are interrogative pronouns or interrogative adjective.

1. What information have you got about the accident?
2. Which is your favourite subject?
3. What do you want?
4. Whom do you want to meet?
5. Whose coat is that?

Relative Pronouns

Read the following pairs of sentences carefully and observe the use of pronouns.

1. **Who** is this boy?
2. This is the boy **who** helped me.
3. **Which** is your coat?
4. This is the coat **which** I bought at the market.

In examples, 1 and 3, 'who' and 'which' are used to ask questions. In examples, 2 and 4, 'who' and 'which' do not ask questions. They are used to join two parts of sentences.

Now examine how the following sentences are joined.

This is the boy. The boy helped me.

This is the boy **who** helped me (who=boy)

In the example given above, the word 'who' is used to replace the noun 'boy'. The word 'who' is called a pronoun. This pronoun also functions as a conjunction as it joins the two sentences in such a way that the pronoun used in one clause relates to the noun in the other. Therefore, it is called a relative pronoun. A noun that a relative pronoun refers to is called its antecedent. In the above example, 'who' is relative pronoun and 'boy' is its antecedent.

Examples:

I saw a man. His beard was very long.

I saw a man **whose** beard was very long. (Whose=man's)

That is the house. I bought it last month.

That is the house **which** I bought last month. (Which=house)

Forms and Cases of Relative Pronouns

	Subjective Case	Objective Case	Possessive Case
For persons	who	whom	whose
For things	what, that	what, that	-
For persons or things	which	which	-

Read the following examples to understand the use and cases of relative pronouns:

1. I met a boy. He was wearing a blue shirt.

I met a boy **who** was wearing a blue shirt.

In the above example, 'who' is the subject of the verb 'wearing', hence it is in **subjective case**.

2. This is the student. The teacher gave him a prize.

This is the student **whom** the teacher gave a prize.

In the above example 'whom' is the receiver or the object of the verb 'gave', hence it is in **objective case**.

3. This is the girl. Her father is a doctor.

This is the girl **whose** father is a doctor.

In the above example, 'whose' shows possession, hence it is in **possessive case**.

4. This is the house. My father built it.

This is the house **which** my father built.

In the above example, 'which' is the object of the verb built, hence it is in **objective case**.

5. All glitters. All is not gold.

All **that** glitters is not gold.

In the above example, 'that' is the subject of the verb glitters, hence it is in **subjective case**.

6. This is it. I expect it of you.

This is **what** I expect of you.

In the above example, 'what' is the object of the verb 'expect', hence it in **objective case**.

Exercise: Tick the correct relative pronouns.

1. I know the girl who/which stole your pen.
2. Do you know the boy whom/what the teacher punished?
3. She saw a man which/whose leg was fractured.
4. The girl who/whom has stood first in the class is my friend.
5. This room has thirty tables what/which are painted red.
6. The Principal gave away prizes to the students which/who had stood first.
7. This is the watch who/which my uncle gifted.
8. These are the girls whose/who notebooks are complete.
9. This is the book whom/which I read last night.
10. My father is the person whom/who I love the most.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with suitable relative pronouns:

1. The boy.....met me in the market is my friend.
2. The man.....they caught was a thief.
3. She is the only person.....is eligible for this post.
4. This is the pen.....my father gifted me.
5. This is the boy.....book went missing yesterday.
6. All.....glitters is not gold.
7. Nothing.....you do now is going to convince me.
8. God helps those.....help themselves.
9. The guests.....we invited to the party could not come.
10. These are the boys.....the teacher appreciated.

Exercise: Join the following pairs of sentences using relative pronouns.

1. This is the man. His brother is missing.

.....

2. He has a brother. The brother is a professor.

.....

3. This is Mrs. Sharma. Everyone likes her.

.....

4. I thanked the stranger. He had helped me.

.....

5. I say something. I mean it.

.....

6. Here are some books. I have selected them for you to read.

.....

Reflexive & Emphatic Pronouns

Reflexive Pronouns

Compound personal pronouns are formed by adding the suffixes '-self' or '-selves' to personal pronouns.

Examples: myself, ourselves, yourself, yourselves, himself, herself, itself and themselves.

A reflexive pronoun refers back to the subject and functions as an object in the sentence. Examples:

1. The children fell down and hurt **themselves**.
2. We enjoyed **ourselves** a lot at the party.
3. She looked at **herself** in the mirror.
4. Mr. Bhatia declared **himself** the new Managing Director of the company.

Reflexive Pronouns				
Person	Number	Personal Pronoun	Reflexive Pronoun	Emphatic Pronouns
First Person	Singular	I	myself	myself
	Plural	we	ourselves	ourselves
Second Person	Singular	you	yourself	yourself
	Plural	you	yourselves	yourselves
Third Person	Singular	he	himself	himself
		she	herself	herself
		it	itself	itself
	Plural	they	themselves	themselves

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with reflexive pronouns.

1. He blamed.....for the loss.
2. Della prepared.....to face the situation.
3. You must take care of.....
4. I availed.....of the opportunity.
5. They set.....down to take their meal.

Emphatic Pronouns

When a compound personal pronoun is used only to lay emphasis on a noun or pronoun, it is called emphatic pronoun. It may be used just after the subject or at the end of the clause. **Examples:**

1. The Principal **himself** declared the holiday.
2. She cleaned the room **herself**.

The above two sentences can be rewritten by removing emphatic pronouns without affecting the meaning.

Thus, emphatic pronouns are used only to lay emphasis.

1. The Principal declared the holiday.
2. She cleaned the room.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with emphatic pronouns.

1. My mother.....prepared these dishes.
2. He carried the heavy luggage.....
3. The students solved the sums.....
4. You.....should talk to the boss.
5. The horse.....broke the rope and ran away.

Indefinite Pronouns

Read the sentences given below carefully.

1. **Somebody** is knocking at the door.
2. **None** has the courage to tell the truth to the Principal.
3. **Everyone** wants to be rich.
4. **Nobody** is perfect in this world.
5. **One** must do **one's** duty.
6. **Nothing** can help me in this situation.
7. I can do **anything** for you.
8. Give me **something** to eat.

The words in bold blue in the above sentences do not refer to any specific or particular person or thing. These words refer to persons and things in general. These words are called indefinite pronouns.

Examples: one, none, all, any, many, several, both, others, much, few, some, someone, somebody, something, everybody, everyone, anyone, anybody, anything, nobody, nothing etc.

Important Notes: The word 'any' 'anyone', 'anybody' and 'anything' are usually used in negative sentences and interrogative sentences. 'One of' is always followed by a plural noun and takes a singular verb.

- Examples:**
- | | |
|-----------------------------|--|
| 1. Do you need anything? | 2. I can't find anybody in the room. |
| 3. Has anyone seen my book? | 4. One of my neighbours has gifted me this book. |

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with indefinite pronouns.

1.is asking about you.
2.is better than.....
3. I am ready to do.....to get this opportunity.
4. Did you askto go?
5.live to be hundred.
6.have tried to cross this forest, butcould do so.
7.in the village believes that this house is haunted.
8. Hasgot a spare pencil?
9. Remember that.....is more important than work.
10. This sum is very easy.can solve it.
11.has already been spoken on the subject.
12.lost their lives in the struggle for independence.

Distributive Pronouns

The pronouns that refer to a single person or thing in a group, one at a time, are called distributive pronouns. **Each, either, neither** are called distributive pronouns. They are always singular and take a singular verb.

Each denotes every one of a number of persons or things in a group taken separately.

Example: **Each** of the boys was given a blanket.

Either and neither are used while speaking about two persons or things. Either means one or the other of the two while neither means not one nor the other of the two.

- Examples:**
1. **Either** of these two books can be purchased. Both are equally good.
 2. **Neither** of these two roads leads to Delhi.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with distributive pronouns:

1. These pens cost rupees fifty.....
2. You can take.....of these two pens.
3.of the two solutions is correct. Try to solve the sum again.
4.of the seats in the hall was occupied.
5.of the twins kept crying.

Reciprocal Pronouns

Pronouns that express a mutual or reciprocal relationship or action are called reciprocal pronouns. There are two pairs of reciprocal pronouns: 'each other', and 'one another'. 'Each other' is used when referring to two people. One another is used when referring to more than two people.

Examples: 1. The two brothers love **each other**. 2. We must respect **one another**.

Correct Use of Pronouns

Exercise: Underline the pronouns in the following sentences. Correct the wrong pronouns in the following sentences and mention their type.

1. There are some boys in the playground. Them are playing football.

.....

2. There is a cat in the kitchen. She is drinking milk.

.....

3. Mohan is in the class. It is writing on the blackboard.

.....

4. There is a book on the table. She is a mathematics book.

.....

5. I always sit with Ritesh. They are friends.

.....

6. I have painted this house ourselves.

.....

7. We have a cow. She gives us milk.

.....

8. Who pencil is this?

.....

9. This are beautiful toys.

.....

10. The climate of Shimla is cooler than those of Ludhiana.

.....

11. The two brothers love one another.

.....

12. Please let I go.

13. They are preparing there lessons.

14. We must respect ours elders.

15. What is your hat?

16. Myself am Raj Malhotra.

17. I have anything important to tell you.

18. My friend and me are going to market.

19. Where is Ritika? Anyone is looking for she.

20. Priya says that this book is her.

21. The officer which you want to meet is on leave.

22. All three partners trust each other.

23. Some of my friends has joined army.

24. She itself cooked all the food.

25. Anyone is knocking at the door.

26. Your's faithfully

27. What is your favourite subject?

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with pronouns:

(a) One dayoffriends came to.....house. My mother was not at home at that time. Iprepared tea for friends. I seated.....in the drawing room.liked the tea I had prepared for..... When mother came home, told that had prepared tea..... My mother was very happy to know..... praised a lot.

(b) The habit of reading is of the greatest resources of mankind, soall must read as much as can. Reading not only entertains but also increases knowledge.should have one's own library. However, must be open for.....and all.

Exercise: Use the following pronouns in your own sentences:

1. One:
2. This:
3. Those:
4. Yours:
5. Himself (Reflexive):
6. Ourselves (Emphatic):
7. Some:
8. All:
9. Mine:
10. Who (Interrogative):

Exercise: The following passage has not been edited. There is an error in each line for which a space has been provided. Underline the incorrect word in the line and write the correct word in the space provided.

Issac Asimov was a popular author, best known for their
science fiction novels and stories. It moved his family to
New York City when she was three years old.....
They studied at Columbia University in New York.
We also wrote over 400 books. He was known for.....
your ability to make complicated subjects easy.
Some of Asimov's most popular books is the novel Robot (1950)